

1. The fact that there are contingent things is contingent.
2. Every contingent fact has an explanation. (PSR)
3. The fact that there are contingent things has an explanation. (1,2)
4. The fact that there are contingent things can't be explained by any contingent thing.
5. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some thing which is not contingent. (3,4)
6. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some necessary thing. (5)
7. There is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things. (6)
8. If there is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things, then God exists.

C. God exists. (7,8)

THE COSMOLOGICAL ARGUMENT

interpretation of Leibniz's

This looks like a plausible

argument.

If this strikes you as a

hypothesis, then premise 8

strange and unlikely

should strike you as a

of Leibniz's argument

plausible one.



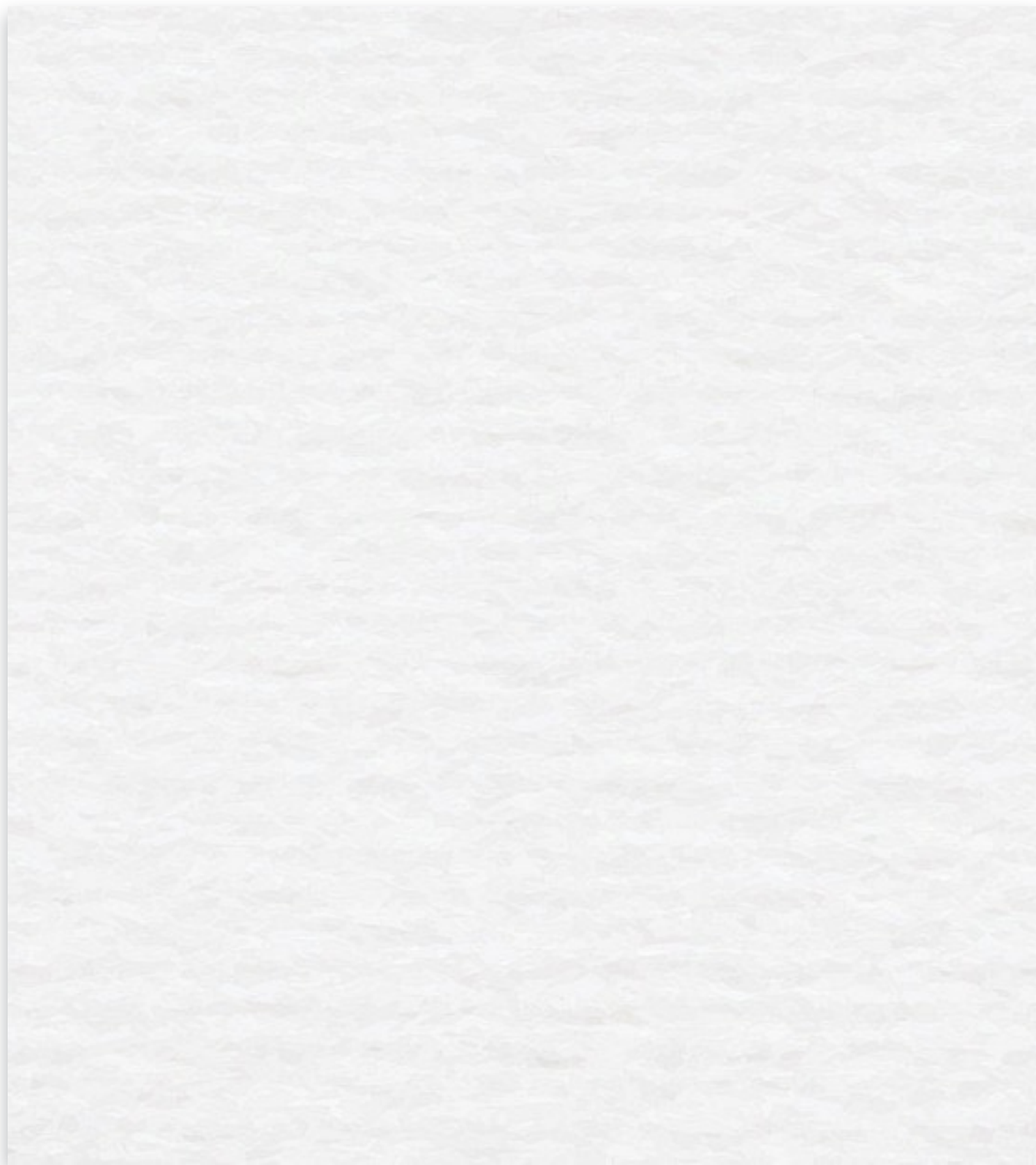
Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR



things is coming.

4. The fact that there are content

2. Every contingent fact has an

containing it. This is.

3. The fact that there are

exp1anation.(PSR)

1. The fact that there are contingent

things has an explanation. (1,2)

explains the experience of

things can't be explained by any

things is explained by some

which is not consistent. $(3, 4)$

necessary thing. (5)

things is explained by some thing



continuing to thrive. (6)

exp1 aims to test the existence of

8. If there is a necessary thing which

6. The fact that there are content

contingent things, then God exists.

7. There is a necessary thing which

C. Godel exists. (7, 8)

5. The fact that there are no

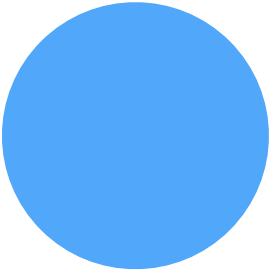


be Good.

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

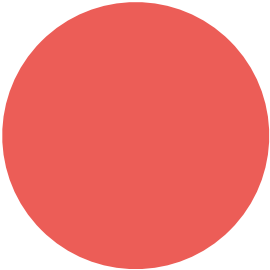
Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could



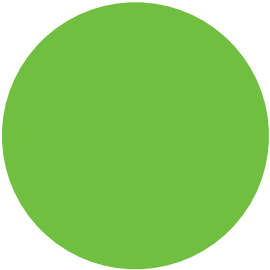












... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.